

To better understand the process of squashing migrations, let's add two new changes to `Promoter`, with a migration file for each. The first change is to add a date of birth field and the second is to add a date of death field. Apply each change separately, creating a migration after each. The end result of `Promoter` is shown in the following listing.

Listing 10.9 Two changes to `Promoter` to be squashed together

```
# RiffMates/promoters/models.py
from django.db import models
```

```
class Promoter(models.Model):
    common_name = models.CharField(max_length=25)
    full_name = models.CharField(max_length=50)
    famous_for = models.CharField(max_length=50)
    birth = models.DateField(blank=True, null=True)
    death = models.DateField(blank=True, null=True)
```

First, add the new `.birth` field, creating a migration immediately afterward. By using `blank=True` and `null=True`, this field is allowed to be empty in the database and the Django Admin.

After migrating the `.birth` field change, follow a similar process to add the `.death` field.

The migration files for these two changes get named: `0006_promoter_birth.py` and `0007_promoter_death.py`. If you've been coding along, your `Promoters` app's migration directory looks like this:

```
RiffMates/promoters/migrations/
├── 0001_initial.py
├── 0002_promoter_famous_for.py
├── 0003_promoter_common_name_promoter_full_name.py
├── 0004_data_fullname.py
├── 0005_remove_promoter_first_name_remove_promoter_last_name.py
├── 0006_promoter_birth.py
├── 0007_promoter_death.py
└── __init__.py
```

Once you have the two migrations, you can squash them together. Squashing is done using the `squashmigrations` management command. This command takes three arguments: the name of the app to be squashed as well as the start and end points of the squashing. The start and end points can either be the full names of the migration files or just enough of their name to uniquely identify them. You can type less by using the number portion of the filename. To squash the birth and death field migrations into a single file, you specify `0006` and `0007` as the squashing targets. The command is as follows:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ python manage.py squashmigrations promoters 0006 0007
Will squash the following migrations:
- 0006_promoter_birth
- 0007_promoter_death
Do you wish to proceed? [yN] y
Optimizing...
No optimizations possible.
```